We see the ice cream cone anti-pattern a lot in organizations where the responsibility of testing falls only on testers. When we were starting our journey to writing automated tests, they began by writing automated tests from a UI perspective and driving all test automation efforts to write them on the E2E level because writing tests involving a UI or a web browser is closer to what our users do. However, it's difficult to convince developers to write tests on the E2E level, not because they don't like to do it, but because tests on the E2E level are more prone to brittleness and are more difficult to maintain. A test is considered flaky when it produces inconsistent results without introducing any changes to the code or environment. To avoid the ice cream cone anti-pattern, there needs to be a good balance of automated tests closer to the code, and contract testing can provide this balance because it's closer to the bottom of the test automation pyramid, as you'll see next.

2.1.5 Contract testing in the test automation pyramid

As mentioned in chapter 1, contract testing brings together the best qualities of both unit and integration tests. To restructure the test automation pyramid slightly, contract tests are found between unit and integration tests, which you can see in figure 2.6.